Weekly Evaluation Rating Criteria

General Guidelines

Score	Description
1	Performance is well below standard. Lacks basic competence. Immediate Remedial training or corrective action is required.
2	Marginal performance. Some elements of basic efficiency, but inconsistently applied. Needs close supervision and guidance.
3	Meets standard. Performs at the level expected of an average solo detective. Reliable, consistent, and generally effective.
4	Above average. Demonstrates strong skills and judgment. Performs with minimal supervision and shows initiative.
5	Exceptional. Consistently exceeds expectations. Demonstrates advanced sound judgment, and professionalism. Could serve as a model for others.

* Scores of 1, 2, and 5 should **always** be explained in the weekly evaluation comments.

Evaluation Categories and Criteria

General Appearance-*Evaluates personal grooming, dress code compliance, and professional presentation.*

- 1: Frequently unkempt, inappropriately dressed, or unprofessional in appearance.
- 3: Consistently maintains a neat, appropriate, and professional appearance in line with Sheriff's Office standards.
- 5: Exemplary professional appearance at all times. Represents the department well in all settings.

Acceptance of Feedback-*Openness to guidance, coaching, and constructive criticism.*

- 1: Dismissive or defensive when given feedback. Resistant to change. Shows little to no improvement in response to criticism.
- 3: Receptive to feedback. Shows willingness to learn and adjust by applying it to improve performance.
- 5: Actively seeks feedback. Integrates it constructively and encourages critique. Shows noticeable growth as a result.

Attitude toward Investigations-*A trainee's curiosity, initiative, and ownership of investigative responsibilities.*

- 1: Indifferent or negative. Lacks initiative or curiosity. Avoids investigative work when possible.
- 3: Shows appropriate and consistent interest and ownership of assigned cases.
- 5: Passionate, highly engaged, self-motivated, and enthusiastic about investigative work.

Knowledge of Policy/Procedures-*Assesses understanding and application of Sheriff's Office policies and established CID procedure.*

- 1: Frequently unaware or in violation of department policy. Requires close supervision most of the time.
- 3: Demonstrates solid (not perfect) working knowledge and proper application of policies.
- 5: Deep understanding; uses policy to inform decisions and helps others understand.

Knowledge of Law/Criminal Procedures-*Evaluates trainee's legal knowledge related to investigations, arrests, and citizens' rights.*

- 1: Misapplies or misunderstands basic criminal legal concepts. Violates citizens' constitutional rights. Creates liability for any stakeholders.
- 3: Correctly applies relevant laws and procedures in most situations. Basic understanding of constitutional law. Mistakes are not egregious.
- 5: Consistently applies the law confidently and accurately. Advises others confidently and accurately.

Response to Initial Investigation-*A trainee's performance upon first responding to a case, including scene assessment, planning, immediate investigative action, and communication with supervisors.*

- 1: Misses key steps in the earliest parts of investigation such as speaking with first responders on scene, thoroughly reviewing reports, preserving scenes, contacting victims within a reasonable amount of time after being assigned to a case.
- 3: Responds in a timely and competent manner. Appropriately secures scene, initiates interviews, and prioritizes investigative tasks. Keeps supervisors informed and sets a solid foundation for follow up.
- 5: Delivers a confident, thorough, and strategic initial response. Demonstrates advanced situational awareness, immediate prioritization, and exceptional judgment. Anticipates follow up needs.

Crime Scene Management-*An assessment of the ability to secure and document scenes; and ability to identify, interpret, and collect evidence.*

- 1: Fails to preserve the scene or secure evidence. Documentation of scene through photos or diagrams is inadequate. Fails to identify evidence.
- 3: Demonstrates competency in securing and managing scenes. Follows standard evidence-handling practices. Documentation is adequate.
- 5: Expertly manages scenes of any complexity; effectively coordinates all investigative elements. Anticipates investigative needs and prevents contamination.

Time Management-*Evaluates punctuality, ability to manage workload, meet deadlines, and prioritizes tasks.*

- 1: Frequently late, disorganized, or unable to prioritize investigative tasks. Regularly misses deadlines.
- 3: Manages time adequately. Meets deadlines and balances workload for the most part.
- 5: Highly organized and efficient. Maximizes productivity without sacrificing quality of work.

Stress Management-*Observations of a trainee's emotional control and professionalism under pressure.*

- 1: Frequently overwhelmed. Reacts poorly under pressure or unpleasant situations. May shut down or react inappropriately.
- 3: Maintains control and composure under typical job-related stress.
- 5: Thrives in high-pressure situations. Remains calm and focused. Stabilizes tense situations for others.

General Investigative Skills-*Evaluates overall capacity to collect, analyze, and interpret information.*

- 1: Needs continuous guidance; lacks core investigative instincts. Misses obvious connections. Fails to identify or grossly misinterprets evidence.
- 3: Capable of conducting thorough investigations with standard oversight. Displays sound judgment when evaluating scenes and evidence.
- 5: Skilled, resourceful investigator. Anticipates issues and follows leads appropriately. Digs deeper than standard practice and uncovers critical details that others would miss.

Interview Skills-*The trainee's ability to conduct suspect, victim, and witness interviews.*

- 1: Unprepared or ineffective. Struggles with building rapport. Fails to seek relevant information. Passive. Engages in coercive behavior. Poor questioning technique.
- 3: Conducts competent, structured interviews. Shows some ability to build rapport. Gathers relevant information.
- 5: Exceptionally skilled at interviewing. Adapts style to the subject being interviewed and the situation. Obtains high-quality information even from difficult subjects.

Report Writing/Documentation-*Assesses the clarity, accuracy, and completeness of a trainee's reports.*

- 1: Reports are incomplete, inaccurate, vague, or poorly written.
- 3: Reports are clear, accurate, and meet professional standards.
- 5: Reports are detailed, well-organized, and readable. Reports are accurate and will stand up to close scrutiny when evaluated alongside other evidence in court.

Computer/Data Entry-*An assessment of the trainee's competence with TriTech, investigative databases, and other digital investigative tools.*

- 1: Repeated errors using TriTech. Noticeable lack of basic computer skills. Resistance to or extreme difficulty learning these systems.
- 3: Regularly demonstrates proficiency in using the majority of relevant systems and databases. Inputs data accurately.
- 5: Efficient and accurate entry of data into TriTech. Resourceful use of digital investigative tools and databases to enhance and streamline investigations.

Problem Solving/Decision Making-*Evaluates logic, judgment, and the ability to resolve investigative challenges.*

- 1: Consistently poor judgement. Relies heavily on others for instruction. Makes risky decisions that don't have any real benefit.
- 3: Makes sound decisions based on available information, policy, and established procedure in routine cases. Seeks input when appropriate.
- 5: Analyzes complex problems effectively and independently. Shows excellent judgment.

Self-Initiated Investigative Skills-*Assesses initiative in developing leads, following up, and pursuing investigations beyond the obvious.*

- 1: Does not follow up or initiate further investigative steps without being prompted externally. Passive.
- 3: Pursues logical investigative leads independently. Proactive.
- 5: Highly proactive. Develops leads independently. Detects crime and responds.

Innovative Investigative Skills-*Concerns the ability to think creatively, the ability to use nontraditional approaches to investigate cases, and overall openness.*

- 1: Rarely considers alternative approaches, rigid, shows little to no curiosity or adaptability.
- 3: Demonstrates openness to creative methods when appropriate. Uses standard techniques well and occasionally supplements with fresh ideas.
- 5: Frequently identifies and applies creative and resourceful solutions. Regularly comes up with original strategies that significantly improve investigative results. Thinks outside the box with sound judgment.

Officer Safety-*Assesses trainee's efforts to protect personal, team, and citizen safety.*

- 1: Regularly disregards safety protocols. Creates risk for self and others. Operates department-issued vehicle in an unsafe manner.
- 3: Maintains good awareness and tactics. Does not create unnecessary risks. Operates vehicle in adequately safe manner.
- 5: Exemplifies tactical awareness. Exemplary driving behaviors. Models safe behavior for others.

Relationships with Citizens-*The trainee's level of professionalism, empathy, and communication with the public.*

- 1: Dismissive, disrespectful, or unprofessional in public interactions.
- 3: Courteous and respectful with the public. Represents the Sheriff's Office appropriately.
- 5: Excellent community presence. Builds trust and rapport. Represents the Sheriff's Office with outstanding professionalism.

Relationships with Coworkers-*Assesses teamwork, communication, and professional rapport within the Sheriff's Office*

- 1: Consistently negative team presence. Dismissive of colleagues. Creates conflict in the workplace.
- 3: Cooperative and respectful. Contributes to a healthy team environment.
- 5: Trusted team player and informal leader. Improves team morale and collaboration.

Work Ethic-*An evaluation of a trainee's reliability, consistency, and willingness to take initiative*

- 1: Unreliable, avoids work, or cuts corners.
- 3: Dependable and consistent in completing assignments.
- 5: Highly driven, dependable, and willing to go above and beyond without prompting.